

candle in the mouth of a bottle, and
putting darkness close down upon man
dilectly to death, on river lamps to
stirring the candles with bush
& straw.

A note just - over impud

one that our 4 centuries of Engraving for
 31 Independent men started at the assault
 of this City, ^{some for miles from} in authors for their supplies
 per ~~the~~ ~~that~~ Boston are compelled to
 sleep on bare bare floors with a simple
 blanket and are taking some colds and
 coughing ~~for~~ ~~fever~~ fearfully. — my injury
 prevents me from any relief but to buy so many
^{more} warm up ticks to be filled with hay to raise
 them ^{and to this the removal of my dog must be the only} from the drafts a little. They are far
 more exposed than they would be on the ground
 under a good tent. — ~~Later~~ I almost every day
 to this when so many of you can count together
 and accomplish so much — dare say your letters
 are so single handed ~~and~~. The future often looks
 dark to me & and it seems sometimes that the
 smiles of Heaven are almost withdrawn from
 our poor rent & distracted country and yet —

there is every thing to be grateful for and
by no means the least is this strongly, well
ventured

But I must desert and ere a period for my
(perhaps unpardonably) long letter, for if you have
followed me thus far, and especially at comparatively
as rapid a rate as I have written you must be
weary. I did not intend to say so much
but let my interest be my apology. And with one
more final word in answer to your rational
question I have done, Ladies remember, that the
call for your organized efforts in behalf of our
army, was not from any Commission or Committee
but from Abraham Lincoln & Simon Cameron
and when they no longer need your help they
will tell you